Joseph Mendoza, ASEP, CSCP

www.linkedin.com/in/josephmendoza524/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Procurement & supply chain AI/IT systems technical leader with 8+ years of experience across direct and indirect categories, consulting, and operational analytics. Proven track record delivering multi-million-dollar savings, leading RFx & vendor negotiations, building and deploying analytics/automation tools, and supporting procurement transformation in high-complexity environments. This combines sourcing/procurement, data analytics, and AI-enabled process improvement to improve spend, speed, and decision quality. Industries I have worked in: Aerospace & Defense, Medical Devices, CPG/Wellness, Automotive & Industrial Auctions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

RB Global, Westchester, IL December 2025 – Present

Procurement Lead/ Procurement Project Manager

- Partners with the Head of Procurement to lead 10 category managers, deliver executive reporting and value-generation analytics across a $1.01B spend portfolio, and advance a $12M+ savings pipeline for 2026.
- Sourced and negotiated suppliers for a new GSA-driven remarketing business line across 13 categories, including glass, collision repair, light mechanical repair, EV chargers, fuel, battery health diagnostics, and condition reporting, contributing an estimated 10% margin improvement worth $6.2M to the bottom line.
- Led diversity spend tracking and reporting for government-regulated operations, supporting contract compliance.
- Built & deployed an IT procurement dashboard tracking 250+ contract renewals & info. security assessment workflows, improving strengthening tech initiative budget forecasting, and lowering renewal risk by $4M.
- Drove enterprise EV charging strategy across 200+ IAA branches, applying electrical engineering analysis and market research to evaluate Level 1 vs. Level 2 charger requirements, then ran an RFQ across 8 suppliers, negotiated a 150-unit charger and Tesla adapter deal, generating $30K in savings. Furthermore, negotiated vendor warranty terms, and launched a self-service punchout catalog for future branch ordering, also driving an estimated $1M in cost avoidance for a major client's EV fleet program.
- Negotiated the transition from an incumbent diesel fuel supplier to a new vendor during a branch expansion in Hamilton, Ontario, standing up 2 new fuel tanks, improving OTD, adding software-based fuel tracking, and securing a lower per-delivery fuel cost for an est. $20K annual savings.
- Built and launched a Perplexity-based AI procurement shared space that automates RFP/RFQ research, supplier negotiations/ redlining, supplier financial health analysis, and stakeholder requirement mapping, generating a scored top 3 vendor shortlist and presentation-ready output for procurement managers; reduced research and analysis time by 150+ hours per sourcing cycle across a team of 10 category managers.
- Orchestrated a two-week AI development sprint with all 14 team members, resulting in 14 deployed AI projects built on Perplexity and MS Power Automate, including travel and expense reconciliation tools, FAQ-driven email response AI agents, IT circuit tracking dashboard, and workload management automation, directly reducing manual effort and scaling workflow automation across the procurement function.
- Launched a spend analytics AI agent chatbot, enabling the team to interact with procurement data and generate custom dashboards on demand, improving spend visibility & removing ad hoc reports.
- Developed an AI-driven supplier risk dashboard for the top 20 suppliers, allowing Chief Executives to input vendor information and instantly view entity-matched risk signals, ticker-linked market data, and consolidated intelligence for faster decision-making.
- Designed and delivered an “AI for Procurement” training program covering the AI ecosystem, LLM fundamentals, and prompt engineering, grounded in graduate-level coursework from the University of Michigan–Flint, enabling team-wide adoption of AI tools across sourcing and procurement workflows.
- Managed procurement support for Oracle ERP launch readiness by validating 50K vendor records, improving supplier taxonomy, strengthening vendor classification for reporting and governance, and building a Python-based cleansing pipeline to distinguish manual-review suppliers from upload-ready records.
- Drove classification of $50M+ in previously unclassified spend by building a procurement taxonomy and using AI-enabled research to classify suppliers and spend data, improving visibility and sourcing insight.
- Coordinated procurement support for five M&A integrations by identifying supplier synergies, rationalizing vendor overlap and supporting contract negotiations across acquired businesses.

- Redlined/negotiated a global brand-merchandise contract that delivered $12K in year 1 cost avoidance, $5K in recurring yearly savings, a $6K fee exposure cap, and a rebate structure yielding $10K-$30K annually.

Glanbia Performance Nutrition (GPN), Downers Grove, IL July 2025 – December 2025

Associate Category Manager/ Procurement Specialist

- Managed $35M+ in annual spend across cocoa, corn-derived sweeteners, blends, fibers, starches, vitamins, minerals, pills, and capsules, delivering a $1.2M+ savings pipeline through dual sourcing, negotiations, RFx, commodity management, and value engineering.
- Led cross-functional RFx for NPI launches across RTD, RTE, supplements, and powders for Optimum Nutrition, Isopure, Amazing Grass, and Think!, aligning specs, supplier capability, and commercialization timelines.
- Executed a global cocoa bid across North America, the UK, India, and APAC, avoiding $580K in contract exposure and reducing projected spend from $16M to $11M in a high-price volatile market.
- Executed a global maltodextrin bid across multiple business units in the UK, Canada, & US, securing $1.5M+ in savings through negotiation and supplier strategy with an established rebate program of 5% per quarter.
- Qualified alternate peanut supply sources under constrained market conditions within 3 weeks, protecting business continuity, removing shortage risk, preventing $165K in lost revenue, and generating $25K in savings.
- Executed RFx across non-commodity categories, delivering $160K+ in additional savings.
- Supported supplement-line redevelopment following an FDA audit, negotiating a 27% reduction in key ingredient cost and $10K in savings per shipment, for total net value of $435K.
- Built an AI data-modeling program to improve shared analytics and visualization across globally integrated procurement teams during a procurement transformation effort.

Preferred Sourcing Solutions (PSS), Oak Brook, IL August 2024 – June 2025

Senior Supply Chain Associate

- Identified an estimated $2M+ in client cost savings opportunities by leveraging expertise in management consulting, strategic sourcing, and spend analysis across diverse industries.
- Led taxonomy development and database architecture for internal and client-facing ETL pipelines, enabling scalable classification systems to support AI-driven sourcing recommendations for their AI Startup: SpendAI
- Performed a telecom license renewal analysis for a client, eliminating roughly 30 underutilized licenses and capturing an estimated $13K in annual savings through usage-based subscription optimization.
- Executed and supported complex sourcing events across IT, Telecom, Software, SaaS, Home Building Materials, and food categories (including poultry), leading RFI/RFP development and supplier evaluations.
- Conducted strategic research initiatives on geopolitical risks, economic outlooks, and supply chain intelligence to guide sourcing decisions and enhance procurement resilience across 40+ industries.

Medline Industries, LP, Mundelein/Waukegan, I.L. Feb 2022 – August 2024

Supply Chain Analyst Rotational Program (SCARP)

- Progressed through five rotational roles spanning supply planning, production control, demand planning, and systems/project management within Medline's kitting and medical device operations.
- **Systems Engineer & Project Manager (Apr 2024–Aug 2024):** Led a 3-person risk mitigation initiative addressing recalls, FDA holds, and safety alerts, developing standardized response plans using the systems "V" model and DMAIC framework that reduced inventory and distribution exposure by $17M.
- **Demand Planning Analyst (Sep 2023 – April 2024):** Managed forecasting for 1,000+ surgical kits and supported Kaizen workshops that identified 22 strategic projects, including a SQL-and Python-based item segmentation analysis that categorized 20% of products for improvement.
- **Supply Chain Planner & Inventory Analyst (March 2023 – Sep. 2023):** Managed portfolios of 700+ medical device components across multiple facilities globally, maintaining 95%+ on-time delivery, and upholding a buffer stock inventory strategy, and coordinating inventory movement to support proper warehousing and distribution; automated a 30-minute manual data-pull process into a 1-minute SQL query.
- **Production Control Analyst (July 2022–Mar 2023)**: Addressed issue tickets for over 3,000 kits in 8 months, coordinating with third-party carriers (USPS, FedEx) to expedite critical shipments; identified ticket-resolution bottlenecks, with 5 of 9 proposed improvements approved, reducing average issue ticket volume from 800 to 300 and saving significant labor time.
- **Buyer (Feb 2022–Jul 2022)**: Managed a portfolio of 1,600+ unique components from 45+ vendors with a $1M weekly purchasing limit, reducing component shortages across 4 plants from 400+ to less than 300, maintaining over 95% on time delivery.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP & CONSULTING

10a Labs, Washington, DC May 2024 – July 2024

Global Data Center Supply Chain Consultant

- Analyzed data center supply chain trends and developed Tableau dashboards on market dynamics, supplier conditions, negotiations insights, and infrastructure-related risk signals to support strategic sourcing decisions.

Halcyox LLC, New York, N.Y. December 2021 – February 2022

Agile Project Manager

- Founded an AI software startup focused on supporting content creating customers with guided solutions for content structure and inspiration in reaching a wider audience; employed agile methodologies to drive operations, resulting in a profit margin of 98% while keeping costs at 2%.

Shipley Center for Innovation, Potsdam, N.Y. April 2018 – October 2018

CAD Technician; Industrial Designer

- Collaborated with a diverse global clientele to design, prototype, and test product concepts; designed schematics of the product concepts for manufacturing production.
- Leveraged proficiency in AutoCAD, Fusion 360, MakerBot, Maya, Rhino, and Additive Manufacturing to create proof-of-concept models and advance towards functional Minimum Viable Products (MVPs).

INTERNSHIPS/CO-OPS

Danbury Mission Technologies, Danbury, C.T. June 2020 – December 2020

Continuous Improvement Subcontracts Supply Chain Engineering Co-op

- Awarded an Innovation Award for successfully creating a GUI into a dynamic dashboard to track buyer savings and headwinds. The tool generates reports from data to stakeholders, saving the company over $370K in yearly labor costs, and cutting a weeklong operation down to the click of a button.
- Developed and executed a curriculum for 5+ departments through Excel spreadsheet models.
- Performed several RFP, RFI, and RFQ processes to solicit suppliers and begin the subcontracting process.
- Automated the negotiations process to better track changes to the terms and conditions.

GE Aviation

Mechatronic Power Systems Engineering Intern, Bohemia, N.Y. June 2019 – August 2019

- Eliminated costs by $100K+ by developing a streamlined assembly process for the power supply unit design of the PAC-3 Missile program.
- Saved the facility thousands in manufacturing and labor costs by pitching a redesign for the capacitors in a power supply unit that would meet customer requirements and increase energy efficiency.

Preliminary Design Mechanical Engineering Co-op, Cincinnati, O.H. August 2018 – December 2018

- Conducted a feasibility analysis on a new concept jet engine using Siemens NX to determine its manufacturability.
- Performed cost and weight analysis upon the Passport 20, CF34-10A, and GEnx engines to calculate the raw material, manufacturing process, and labor costs for each part to be sent to airframers. Results were compiled into data packages currently used for future jet engine designs.

EDUCATION

University of Michigan-Flint, Flint, M.I. 2025 – Present

M.S., Software Engineering; Concentration: Artificial Intelligence (AI); GPA: 4.0

- **Handshake AI Fellowship:** Performing research to evaluate the accuracy of AI Models.

University of Michigan Rackham Graduate School, Ann Arbor, M.I. 2022 – 2024

M. Eng., Systems Engineering & Design

- **GSAC Professional Development Chair:** Hosted professional dev. Workshops between Industry & students.

Clarkson University, Potsdam, N.Y. 2017 – 2021

Dual B.S., Global Supply Chain Management & Political Science, Minors in Quality-Based Project Management, Computational Science, and Mathematics

Awards: Phalanx Commendable Leadership Award, DEI Champion Award, Gorbel Inc. Honor Scholarship

- **Applied Mathematics Research Assistant:** Developed a predictive model using rod cell data from zebrafish to estimate the potential extent of visual impairment in humans.
- **Environmental Policy Research Assistant:** Conducted research on the factors influencing willingness to invest in solar energy systems in New York State.

SKILLS

- **Procurement & Sourcing:** Strategic sourcing, category management, RFx (RFP/RFI/RFQ), negotiations, contract management, spend analysis, cost savings, risk management, Punchout Catalogs, should-cost analysis, procurement transformation, M&A integration, rebates, diversity spend tracking, SAP Ariba, IBIS World, DFAR/FAR
- **Analytics & Systems:** Github, VS Code, Anaconda, SQL, Python, R, Excel/VBA, Power BI, Tableau, SAP ECC, SAP APO, Oracle NetSuite, AS400, ETL, taxonomy design, dashboard development, data modeling, statistical analysis.
- **Project & Process Improvement:** Agile methodologies, DMAIC, project management, Sprints, Kaizen, inventory optimization, demand planning/forecasting, cross-functional project leadership, systems engineering (V-model), Lean manufacturing, risk analysis, IBM Planning Analytics, Oracle ERP Implementation
- **Technical & Design Tools:** MS Project/Access/Visio/Excel, Perplexity.AI, ChatGPT, Replit, Ignite.no, Langchain, Python, VBA, MATLAB, Fusion 360, Miro, Cameo MagicDraw, SIPMath, XLDyn, XLTree, ANSYS, CURA, Siemens NX, Octoparse, JIRA, AmplifiPRO, Monday.com, Google Suite, API, AutoCAD.
- **Certifications:** Certified Supply Chain Professional (CSCP), GAP Essential Negotiator, Associated Systems Engineering Professional (ASEP), Certified Six Sigma Yellow Belt (CSSYB), Certified AutoCAD User.